ESSENTIAL ENGLISH

Grammar for IT Interviews

IT

Key grammar skills to succeed in your interview

IT English Training · 4 November 2026

Wh-Questions vs. Direct Questions

Choose the question type that matches your interview goal.

OPEN

Wh-questions

What · Where · Why · How

Request information and explore skills or experience.

“What programming languages do you use?”

CONFIRM

Direct questions

Yes / No or a specific inquiry

Use these to verify a fact.

“Do you have experience with Java?”

PRACTICE

Write one Wh-question for each topic: teamwork · problem solving · project experience.

Indirect and Polite Forms

Soften a direct question to sound professional and collaborative.

STARTER 01

I’d like to ask…

“I’d like to ask about your experience with cloud computing.”

STARTER 02

Could you tell me…

“Could you tell me how you handle tight deadlines?”

STARTER 03

Would you mind…

Follow with a gerund: “Would you mind explaining your approach?”

PRACTICE

Convert these: “What is the deadline?” · “Explain your testing process.”

Prepositions in Context

Learn the whole work phrase—not the preposition alone.

PHRASE

work at

a company
I work at TechSolutions.

PHRASE

work for

a person/company
I work for a start-up.

PHRASE

work in

a field/team
I work in security.

PHRASE

responsible for

tasks/projects
She is responsible for testing.

PHRASE

good at

skills
He is good at debugging.

PRACTICE

Fill in: I work ___ data engineering. · I am responsible ___ deployment. · I am good ___ troubleshooting.

Build Vocabulary with Word Parts

Prefixes change meaning; suffixes often change the word class.

PREFIXES

Add meaning before the root

un- → unreliable
self- → self-taught
pre- → pre-installed

SUFFIXES

Build useful nouns

-er → programmer
-ment → development
-tion → installation

PRACTICE

Create new words adding a prefix or suffix: working - secure - create - knowledge

Present Simple vs. Present Continuous

Separate your regular role from what is happening now.

ROUTINE / FACT

Present Simple

Base verb; add -s for he/she/it.

“I manage databases.”
“I work in IT.”

NOW / TEMPORARY

Present Continuous

am / is / are + verb-ing

“I am currently working on a mobile app.”

PRACTICE

Choose the tense: I usually ___ (test) APIs, but this week I ___ (build) a prototype.

Present Perfect: Result or Duration?

Both connect the past to the present—but they focus differently.

RESULT / EXPERIENCE

have / has + past participle

Focus on completed experience or achievement.

“I have completed several projects.”
“I have used Java for five years.”

ONGOING ACTIVITY

have / has been + verb-ing

Focus on duration or continuing effort.

“I have been improving my coding skills.”

PRACTICE

Complete: We ___ (deploy) three releases. · I ___ (work) on this project for two months.

Tell a Clear Past Story

Use three forms to sequence finished actions, background events, and old habits.

FINISHED

Past Simple

“I developed the app last year.”

IN PROGRESS

Past Continuous

“I was debugging when the server crashed.”

OLD HABIT

Used to

“I used to work on front-end development.”

PRACTICE

Complete a short incident story using: was testing · occurred · used to.

Future Simple vs. Future Continuous

Express a decision—or show an action in progress at a future time.

PREDICTION / DECISION

will + base verb

“I will learn new frameworks.”
“I will attend the workshop.”

FUTURE IN PROGRESS

will be + verb-ing

“Tomorrow, I will be presenting my project.”
“I will be working on the update.”

PRACTICE

Write two career plans: one with will, and one with will be + verb-ing.

Conditional Sentences

Match the form to certainty: fact, real possibility, or hypothetical.

ZERO

If + present, present

Fact or reliable result.

“If I debug the code, it runs better.”

FIRST

If + present, will

Real future possibility.

“If I study hard, I will pass.”

SECOND

If + past, would

Hypothetical.

“If I were a manager, I would delegate.”

PRACTICE

Complete: If the build fails, I ___. · If I led the team, I would ___.

Modal Verbs: Intent in One Word

Use the modal to signal ability, politeness, invitation, or advice.

ABILITY

CAN

I can troubleshoot network issues.

POLITE REQUEST

COULD

Could you send me the report?

OFFER / REQUEST

WOULD

Would you like to join the meeting?

ADVICE

SHOULD

You should document your code.

PRACTICE

Choose can, could, would, or should: ___ you explain this code? · You ___ add unit tests.

Talk About Motivation with Gerunds

After expressions of likes and passion, use the -ing form.

STRUCTURE

enjoy / like / love / hate + verb-ing

Also: be passionate about + verb-ing

Keep the verb as an activity.

INTERVIEW-READY EXAMPLES

Show what energizes you

“I enjoy working under pressure.”
“She loves solving complex problems.”
“We are passionate about developing efficient software.”

PRACTICE

Complete with gerunds: I enjoy ___. · I am passionate about ___. · I dislike ___.

Integrated Practice

Combine the grammar. Leave space, write, then say each answer aloud.

01

Ask politely about the role's daily tasks.

_____

02

Complete: I work ___ cloud security.

_____

03

Choose: I have built / have been building five apps.

_____

04

Complete: If I get the role, I ___ improve monitoring.

_____

05

Finish: I enjoy ___ complex systems.

_____

06

Write one past incident using while.

_____

Grammar Toolkit: One-Page Recap

Select the structure that best communicates your meaning.

QUESTIONS

Wh- for detail; direct for confirmation; polite forms for tone.

TIME

Present for now; perfect for experience; past for stories; future for plans.

CONNECTIONS

Prepositions belong to phrases; word parts expand vocabulary.

POSSIBILITIES

Conditionals express facts, real outcomes, and hypotheticals.

INTENT

Modals signal ability, requests, offers, and advice.

MOTIVATION

Gerunds follow likes, dislikes, and passion expressions.

Final Tips for Interview Grammar

Accuracy matters—but clarity, control, and confidence matter more.

01

Speak clearly and politely

Pause before long answers. Use polite question starters when you need clarification.

02

Use time precisely

Vary tenses to distinguish your role, achievements, incidents, and plans.

03

Rehearse out loud

Practice common questions and build short, truthful responses you can adapt.

Questions & Further Practice

Turn uncertainty into a precise question—and keep practicing in context.

REFLECT

What still feels difficult?

Write one grammar doubt. Add the interview sentence where it appears. Ask for a correction and the reason behind it.

NEXT STEPS

Practice little and often

Record mock answers · review job descriptions · build a phrase bank · exchange peer feedback · repeat corrected answers.

Thank you for your attention!

You have the grammar. Now make your experience heard.

GO

IT English Training · 4 November 2026